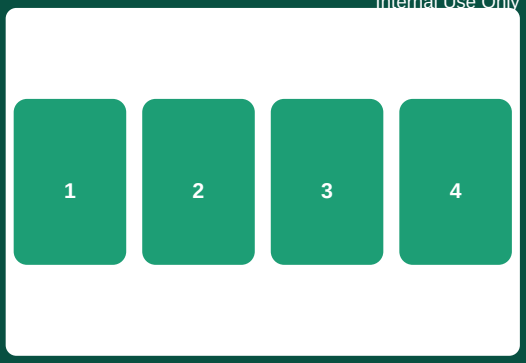
Internal Use Only

Chalk Circle

Develop deep process observation skills by standing in one location for an extended period and systematically recording



WHEN TO USE

Before designing improvements; when assumptions about how a process actually works need to be tested against reality.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Select a critical observation point in the process
2. Stand or mark the spot — observe for 30–60 minutes without interrupting
3. Record everything: activities, problems, waste, variation, unsafe conditions
4. Do not intervene during the observation period
5. Debrief findings with the improvement team immediately after

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Bring a notebook, not a laptop. The act of handwriting slows you down and forces you to notice what you would otherwise filter out.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Structured observation log
- Problem and waste priority list
- Insights that reshape the improvement plan

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Number of problems identified per observation hour; insights that change the improvement direction

TOOL CATEGORY

Quality & Process